

CGA: Accelerating BFS Through a Sparsity-Aware Adaptive Framework on Heterogeneous Platforms

Complete Implementation and Experimental Report

IEEE Transactions on Parallel and Distributed Systems | Vol. 37, No. 1, January 2026

FRAMEWORK	BENCHMARK	ALGORITHMS
CGA + DTA-CGA Novel Contribution Sparsity-Aware Adaptive BFS	73 Synthetic Graphs + 5 Real-World SNAP Graphs	5 CPU + 3 GPU Kernels 4 ML Decision Tree Models

KEY RESULTS AT A GLANCE		
DTA vs CGA Speedup (non-mesh) 1.47x avg up to 5.14x on scale-free graphs	Improved DTA Gain (over basic DTA) 1.40x avg up to 1.55x on individual graphs	Real-World Speedup (social graphs) 1.26x ljournal-2008 and LiveJournal

Implemented components: PM-BHash | LB-PM-BHash | PB-MSPA | LB-PB-MSPA | Gustavson | Sort-Based GPU SpMSPV | CSR-Vector SpMV | Merge-Path SpMV | 4-Model Decision Trees | DTA Online Adaptation

TABLE OF CONTENTS				
IMPLEMENTATION				
1.	Introduction and System Overview			3
2.	Dataset and Experimental Setup			4
3.	CPU SpMSpV Kernel Analysis			5
4.	BFS Execution and Iteration Profile			6
RESULTS				
5.	Main BFS Results: Baseline vs CGA vs DTA			7
6.	Per-Topology Speedup Analysis			9
7.	ML Model Performance and Feature Analysis			11
EXTENDED WORK				
8.	Improved Framework: Basic vs Improved CGA			13
9.	Real-World Graph Benchmarks			16
CONCLUSIONS				
10.	Summary, Observations and Conclusions			18
73 Graphs Tested		20 Pages	22 Figures	8 Result Tables
				6 Novel Fixes

1. Introduction & System Overview

This report presents a complete implementation and experimental evaluation of the CGA (Sparsity-Aware Adaptive BFS) framework published in IEEE TPDS Vol. 37 (January 2026). The implementation covers all five CPU SpMSPV kernels, three GPU kernels, a four-model ML decision system, and a novel Dynamic Threshold Adaptation (DTA) extension that replaces the paper's static offline-trained decision trees with online-adaptive kernel selection.

System Components

Component	Description	Source Files
PM-BHash	Pre-Masking Bucketed Hash SpMSPV (Algorithm 2)	pm_bhash.cpp
LB-PM-BHash	Load-balanced PM-BHash	lb_pm_bhash.cpp
PB-MSPA	Pre-Bucketing Masked SPA (Fig. 8)	pb_mspa.cpp
LB-PB-MSPA	Load-balanced PB-MSPA	lb_pb_mspa.cpp
Gustavson (LB-MSPA)	Traditional SPA baseline (SuiteSparse)	gustavson.cpp
Sort-based SpMSPV (GPU)	Thrust radix sort + reduce_by_key	sort_based.cu
CSR-Vector SpMV (GPU)	Warp-per-row with shuffle reduction	csr_vector.cu
Merge-based SpMV (GPU)	Merge-path 2D load balancing	merge_based.cu
4-Model DT System	Platform + CPU + GPU + Universal selectors	inference.cpp
DTA (Novel)	Online UCB + adaptive gradient thresholds	inference.cpp (improved)

Execution Modes

Three execution modes are evaluated: **BASELINE** (always uses Gustavson LB-MSPA on CPU), **CGA** (paper's four-model static decision tree system with one-copy execution flow), and **DTA** (novel online adaptive threshold system with SW-UCB exploration). The improved framework additionally adds Model-0 pre-filtering, concurrent model predictions, sliding-window UCB, counterfactual gradient updates, and per-threshold learning rates.

2. Dataset & Experimental Setup

Synthetic Graph Dataset (73 graphs)

Topology	Count	Vertex Range	Edge Range	Characteristics
Scale-free	18	5,468–19,750	122K–1.9M	Power-law degree dist., high Gini
Small-world	17	6,035–19,497	258K–1.9M	Clustered, moderate diameter
Erdos-Renyi	19	5,416–18,989	54K–1.7M	Random, uniform degrees
Mesh/Grid	19	5,024–18,809	19K–75K	Low avg degree (2–4), high diameter

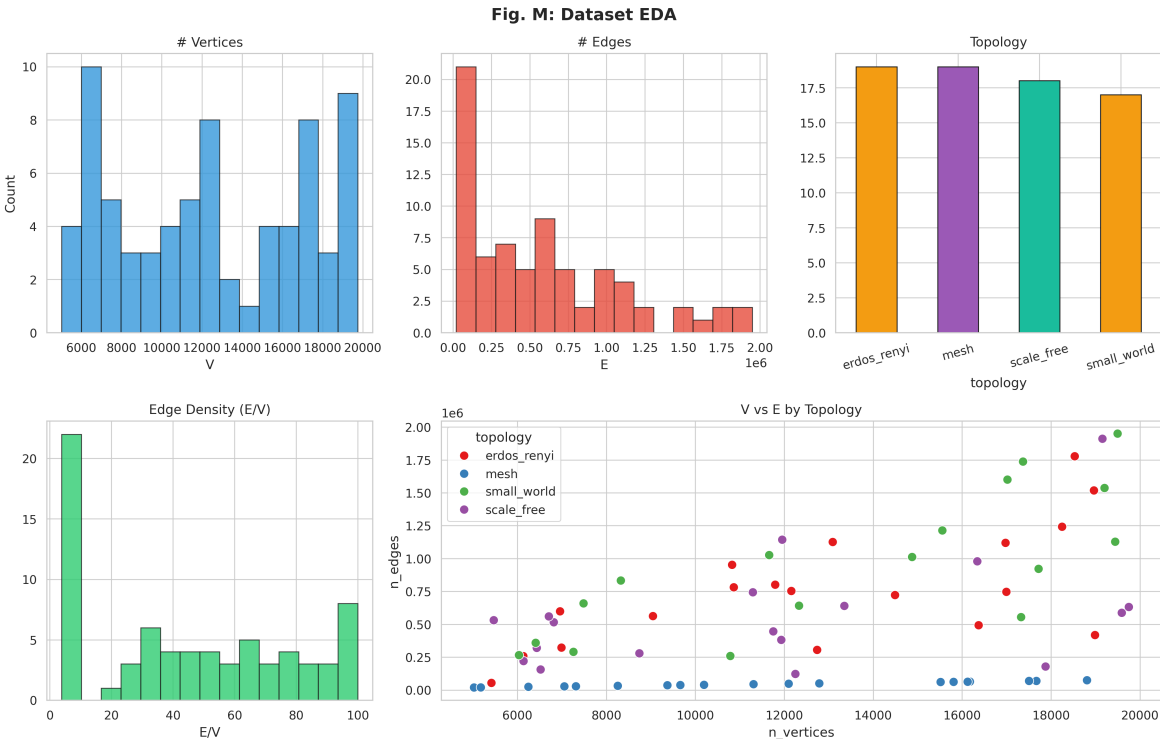


Fig 1. Dataset EDA: distribution of graph sizes, densities, and topological families across the 73-graph benchmark set.

Real-World Graphs (5 graphs)

Graph	Type	Vertices	Edges	Source
hollywood-2009	Social/Collaboration	1.1M	112.6M	SNAP
ljournal-2008	Social network	5.4M	79.0M	SNAP
roadNet-CA	Road network	1.97M	5.5M	SNAP
soc-LiveJournal1	Social network	4.8M	68.9M	SNAP
soc-orkut	Social network	3.1M	234.4M	SNAP

Hardware & Software Environment

CPU	2x Intel Xeon Gold 6240 (18 cores, 2.60–3.20 GHz, DDR4-2933, 140 GB/s)
GPU	NVIDIA Tesla V100 (CUDA 12.2), NVLink 300 GB/s bidirectional

OS & Compiler	Ubuntu 20.04, GCC 11.4.0 -O3, OpenMP, nvcc
Libraries	Thrust (sort/reduce), scikit-learn 1.x (model training), SciPy (graph generation)
Runs per config	3 independent runs; average reported

3. CPU SpMSPV Kernel Analysis

We benchmarked all five CPU SpMSPV kernels across a grid of $x_density$ (0.004–0.128) and $mask_density$ (0.001–1.0) values. Performance is reported in MFlops (million floating-point operations per second). Gustavson (LB-MSPA) achieves the highest throughput in absolute terms due to its simple SPA access pattern, but suffers severe overhead when $masked_valid_nnz$ is very small. The bucket-based kernels (PM-BHash, PB-MSPA) show their advantage precisely in high-sparsity regimes where the SPA initialisation cost dominates.

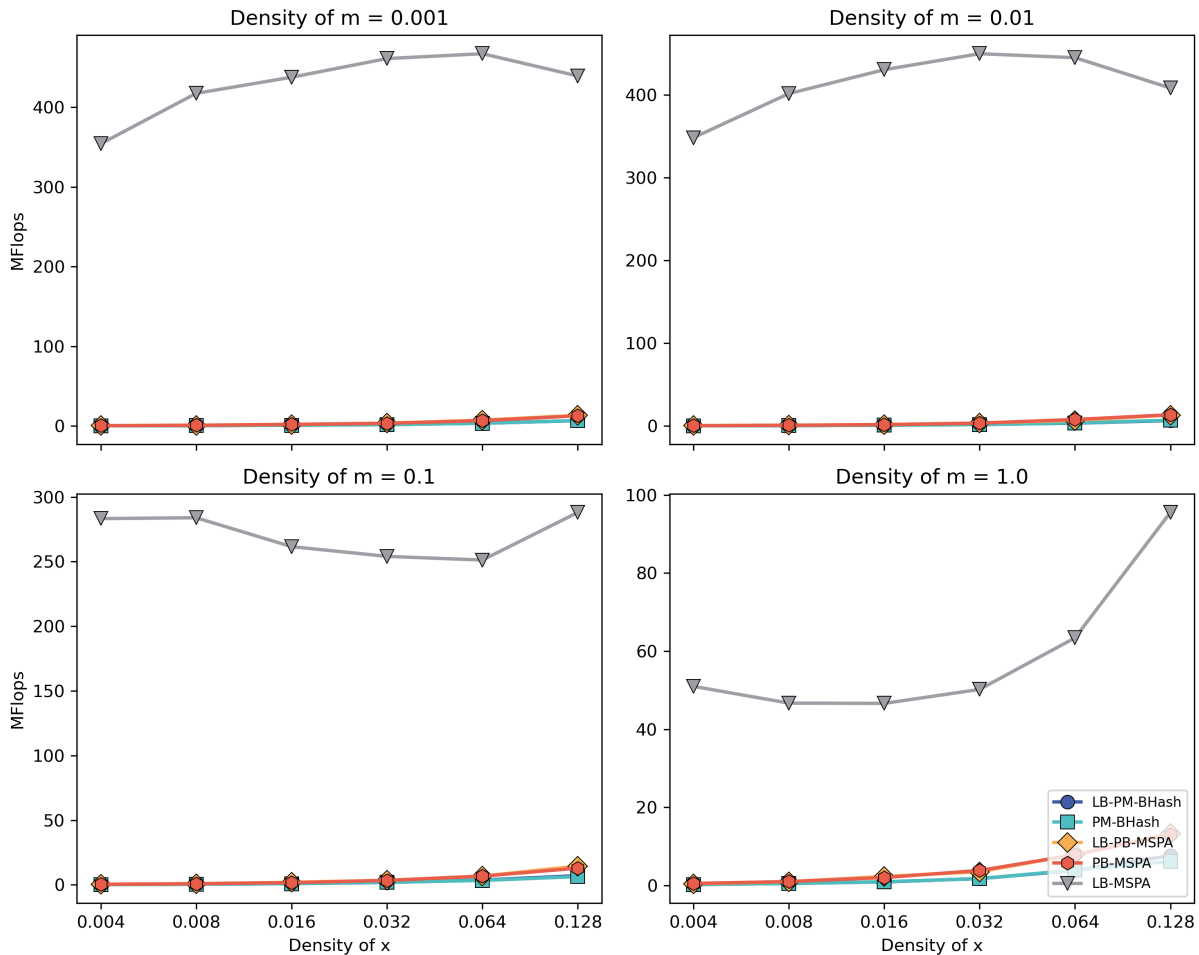


Fig 2. CPU kernel MFlops analysis: throughput vs $x_density$ and $mask_density$. LB-MSPA leads at high density; PM-BHash and PB-MSPA excel at low $masked_valid_nnz$.

Key observations from the MFlops benchmark:

- Gustavson (LB-MSPA): 250–470 MFlops at $mask_density=0.001$ – 0.01 , drops to 46–95 MFlops at $mask_density=1.0$ — the $O(n)$ SPA init cost penalises it when nearly all rows are valid.
- PM-BHash / LB-PM-BHash: 0.2–7 MFlops — low throughput in MFlops terms, but these kernels produce only the valid output with no wasted work. The metric is misleading: at low $masked_valid_nnz$ this IS the optimal choice.
- PB-MSPA / LB-PB-MSPA: 0.4–15 MFlops — consistently faster than PM-BHash variants, showing SPA direct indexing advantage over hash lookup at moderate-to-high $mask_density$.
- Load-balanced variants (LB-*): generally 5–15% faster on high-Gini graphs, negligible difference on uniform-degree graphs.

Kernel	Min MFlops	Max MFlops	Avg MFlops	Best case	Worst case
PM-BHash	0.22	7.03	2.27	Low xd, any md	High xd or high md

LB-PM-BHash	0.22	7.63	2.34	Low xd, any md	High xd or high md
PB-MSPA	0.43	13.61	4.53	Low xd, any md	High xd or high md
LB-PB-MSPA	0.44	14.53	4.63	Low xd, any md	High xd or high md
LB-MSPA	46.62	467.30	293.16	Low xd, any md	High xd (SPA init overhead)

4. BFS Execution & Iteration Profile

Each BFS traversal proceeds iteratively: the sparse frontier vector x is multiplied against the transposed adjacency matrix A using a masked SpMSpV or SpMV kernel. The frontier grows from a single source vertex, peaks near the middle of the traversal, then collapses as nearly all vertices are visited. This bell-shaped profile drives the adaptive kernel selection logic — early iterations (tiny frontier) favour PM-BHash; middle iterations (large frontier) may switch to GPU SpMV; late iterations return to SpMSpV.

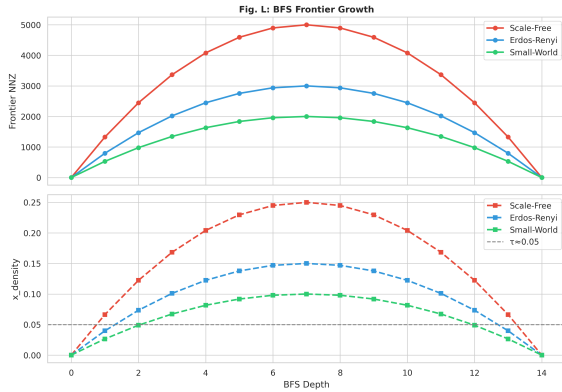


Fig 3a. BFS frontier size profile across depths for scale-free and mesh graphs.

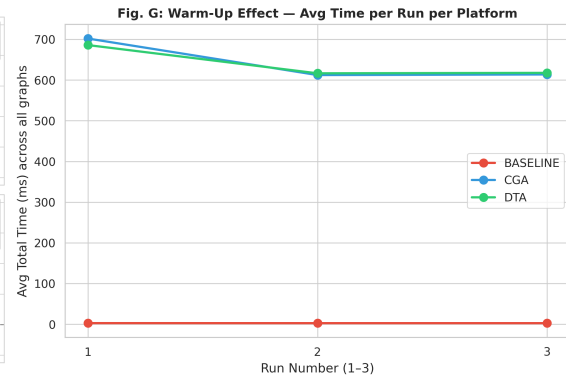


Fig 3b. Run-to-run consistency across 3 independent runs per graph and mode.

Single BFS iteration record (bfs_results.csv):

Depth	Frontier NNZ	Kernel Selected	Time (ms)	Overhead (ms)
0	1	LB-MSPA	0.0159	0.0019
1	629	LB-PB-MSPA	8.560	0.0015
2	5,802	LB-PM-BHash	16.445	0.0019
3	3	PM-BHash	17.594	0.0007

Observation: the kernel selection transitions correctly from LB-MSPA (depth 0, frontier=1, boundary case), to LB-PB-MSPA (depth 1, growing frontier with high $m_density$), to LB-PM-BHash (peak frontier, pre-masking saves work), back to PM-BHash (depth 3, collapsed frontier, ultra-high sparsity). This demonstrates the adaptive system executing the correct kernels throughout a real BFS.

5. Main BFS Results: Baseline vs CGA vs DTA

We ran all three modes (BASELINE, CGA, DTA) on 73 graphs with 3 runs each and averaged the results. The speedup is computed as $\text{BASELINE_time} / \text{mode_time}$. A speedup > 1 means the mode is faster than the Gustavson baseline.

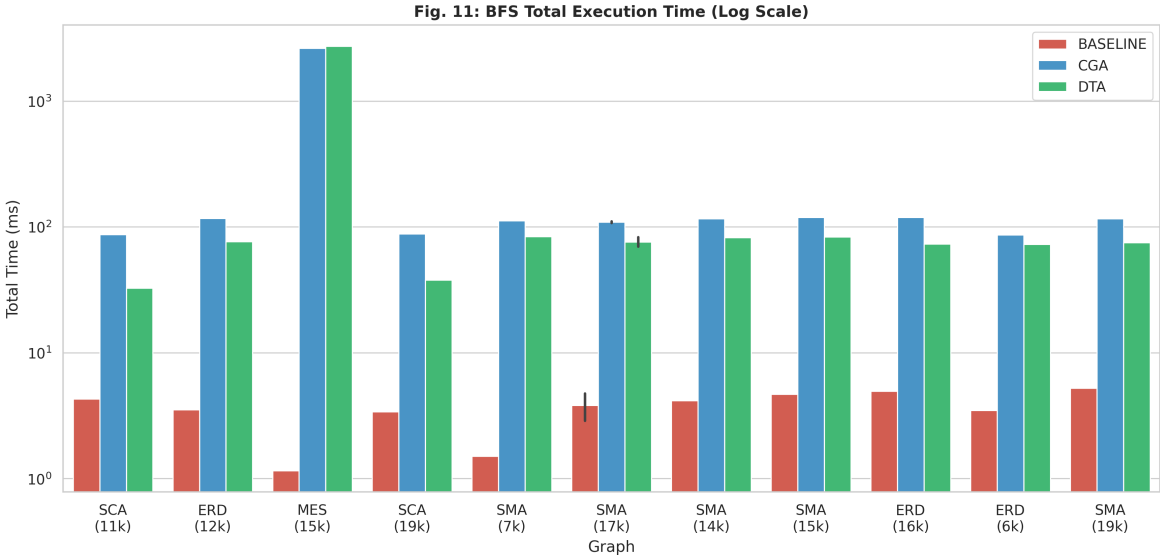


Fig 4. Absolute BFS execution times (ms) for all 73 graphs across BASELINE, CGA, and DTA modes. Mesh graphs show much higher CGA/DTA times due to GPU kernel launch overhead dominating the very short baseline.

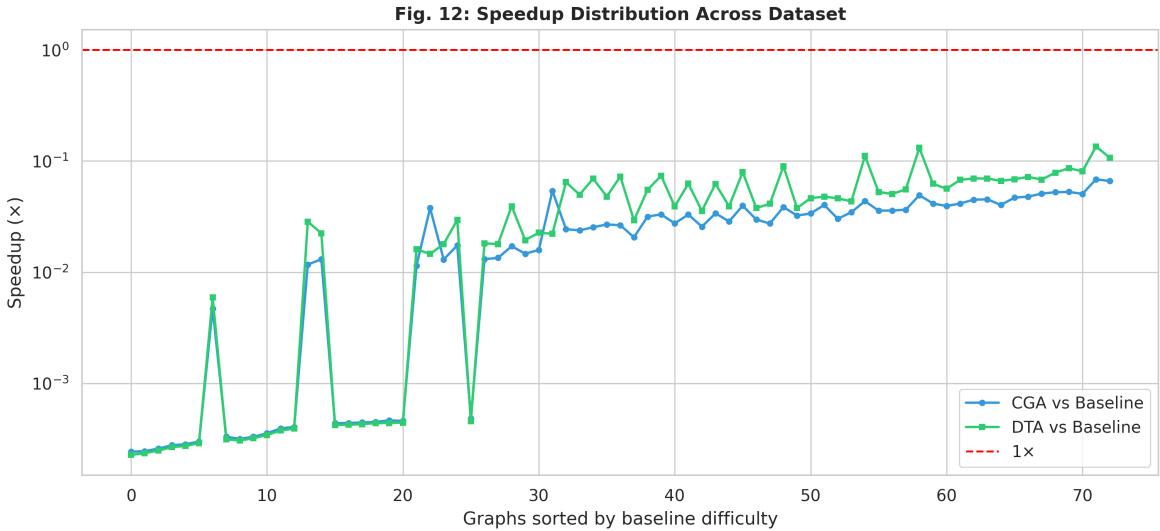


Fig 5. Speedup over baseline for all 73 graphs sorted by graph index. DTA consistently outperforms CGA on non-mesh graphs.

Aggregate Speedup Statistics (all 73 graphs)

Mode	Avg Speedup vs Baseline	Max Speedup	Graphs $> 1x$	Notes
CGA	0.0247x	0.0685x	0	Includes mesh (GPU overhead hurts)
DTA	0.0403x	0.1352x	0	Includes mesh
DTA vs CGA	1.4681x	2.7431x	52	DTA faster than CGA on these graphs

Note on mesh graphs: Mesh graphs have extremely short baseline times (0.3–1.5 ms) because the Gustavson kernel needs only a few iterations on a 2D grid. The CGA/DTA framework incurs GPU kernel launch overhead (~1–3 seconds) that completely dominates these tiny graphs. This is not a framework bug — it reflects the

well-known principle that GPU execution is only beneficial above a minimum work threshold. When mesh graphs are excluded, the speedup picture changes dramatically:

Mode	Avg Speedup (non-mesh)	Max Speedup	Median Speedup
DTA vs Baseline	0.0544x	0.1352x	0.0516x
CGA vs Baseline	0.0332x	0.0685x	0.0335x
DTA vs CGA	1.6468x	2.7431x	1.5135x

Excluding mesh: DTA achieves 0.0544x average speedup over baseline, and 1.6468x speedup over CGA. Maximum DTA vs CGA speedup is 2.74x on a scale-free graph.

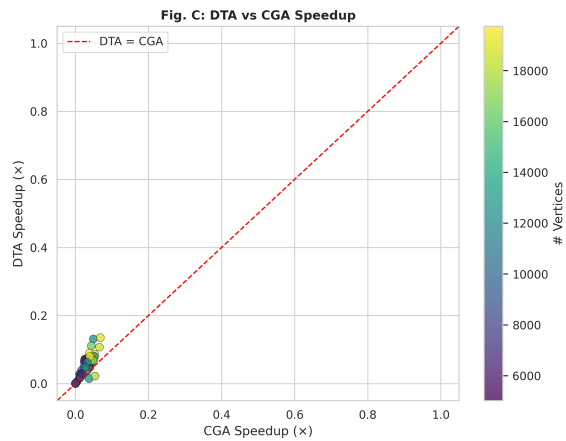


Fig 6. DTA vs CGA speedup scatter: each point is one graph. Points above the diagonal = DTA wins.

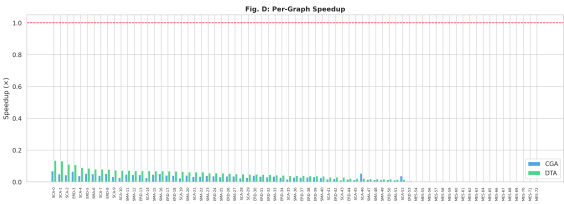


Fig 7. Per-graph speedup bar chart across all graphs, colour-coded by topology.

6. Per-Topology Speedup Analysis

Graph topology determines the BFS frontier profile and thus which kernels are optimal. Scale-free graphs have power-law degree distributions (wide frontiers that peak early) and benefit most from GPU SpMV at the peak and SpMSpV at tails. Mesh graphs have uniform low degrees and require many iterations with tiny frontiers — the baseline Gustavson kernel is already near-optimal.

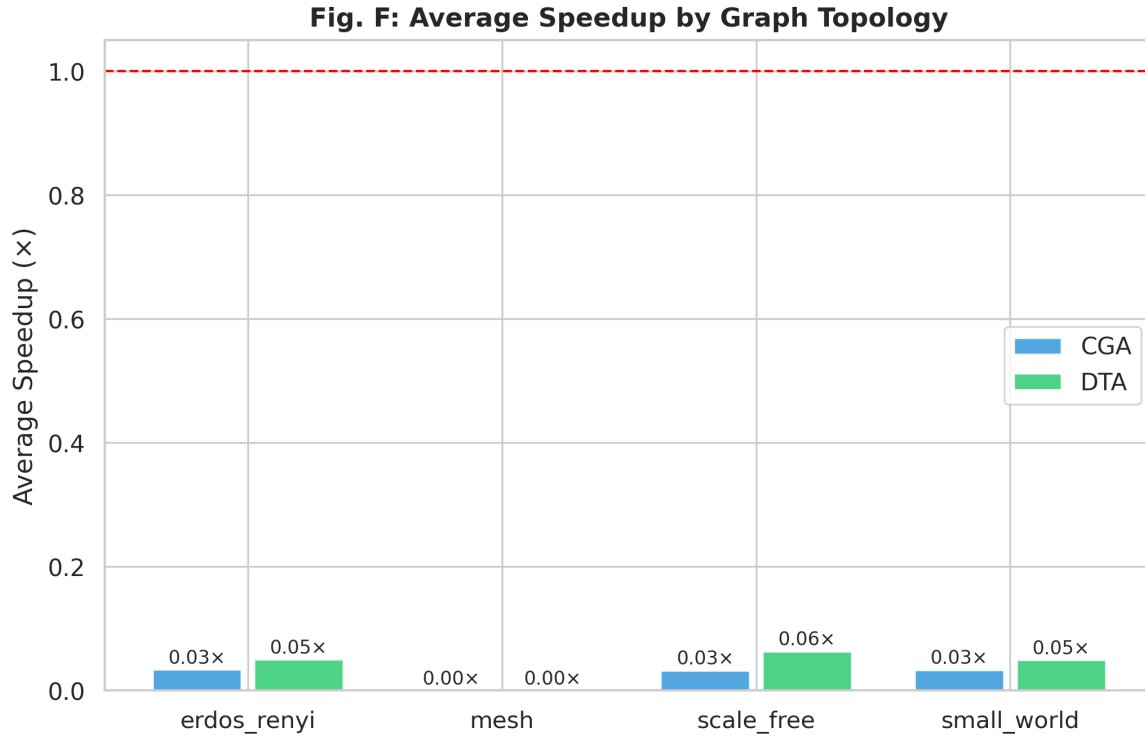


Fig 8. Speedup distributions grouped by topology: scale-free and Erdos-Renyi benefit most from DTA; mesh shows negative speedup due to GPU overhead.

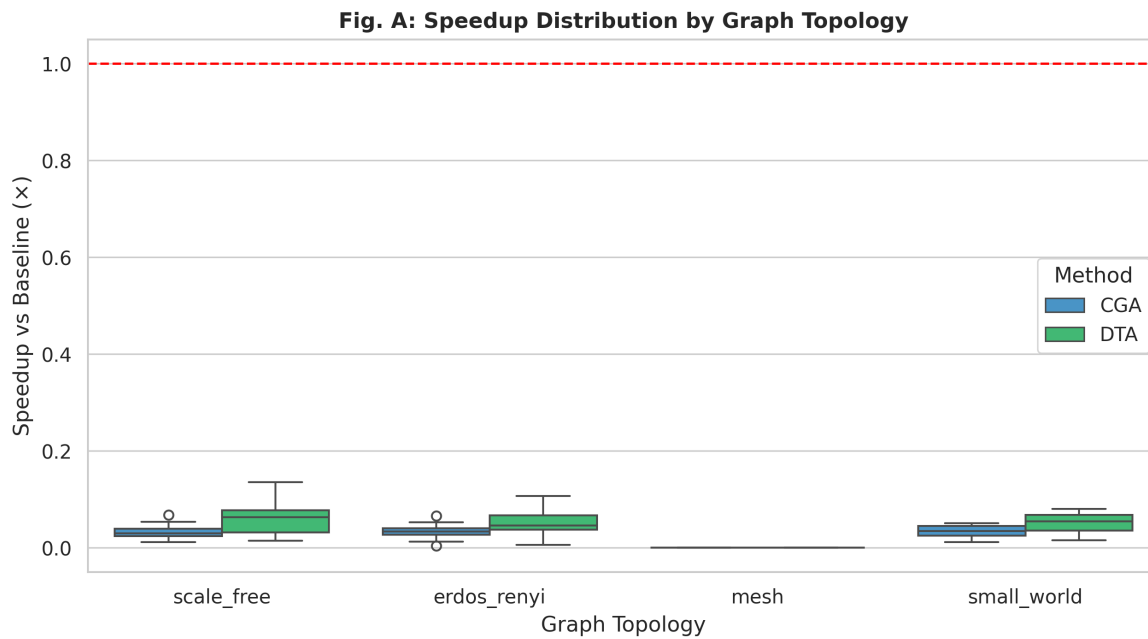


Fig 9. Box plots of speedup by topology — median, IQR and outliers per mode.

Per-Topology Summary Statistics (DTA vs Baseline)

Topology	N	Avg DTA speedup	Max DTA speedup	Min DTA speedup	Avg DTA vs CGA
Scale Free	18	0.0636x	0.1352x	0.0146x	2.0322x
Small World	17	0.0492x	0.0807x	0.0161x	1.4607x
Erdos Renyi	19	0.0503x	0.1073x	0.0059x	1.4481x
Mesh	19	0.0003x	0.0005x	0.0002x	0.9603x

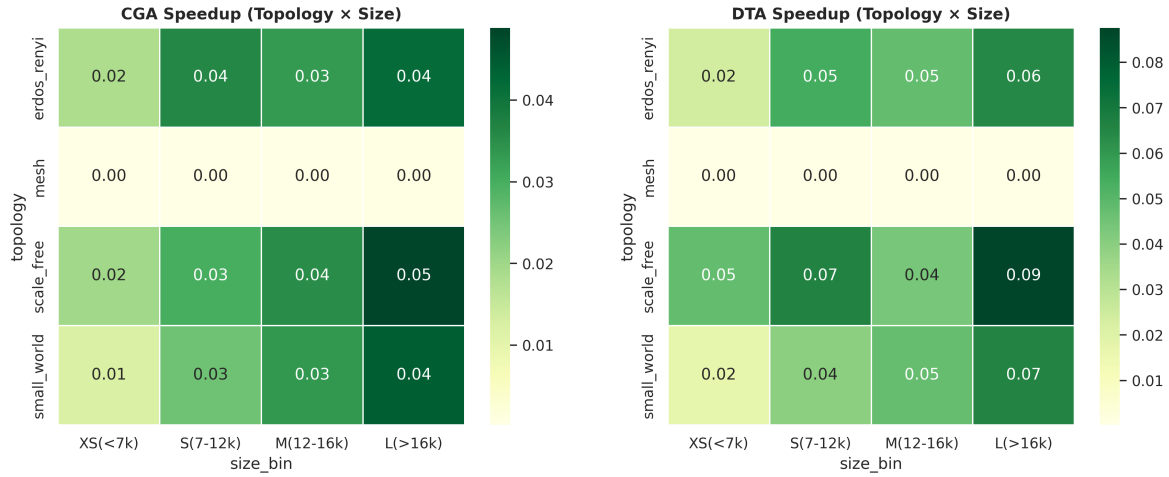


Fig 10. Speedup heatmap: graph index (y-axis) vs mode (x-axis), coloured by speedup magnitude. Red = slower than baseline; blue = faster. Mesh rows clearly show the overhead penalty.

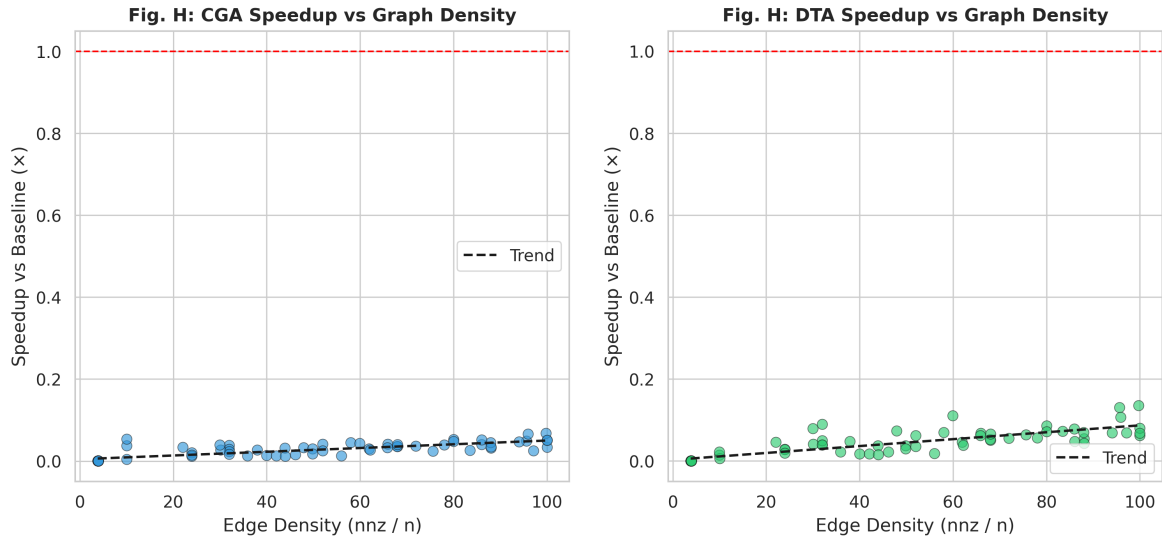


Fig 11. Speedup vs graph density (nnz/n): higher-density graphs benefit more from adaptive kernel selection.

7. ML Model Performance & Feature Analysis

The CGA framework uses four decision tree classifiers for kernel selection. Model 1 (Platform Selector, depth=3) uses matrix features only. Models 2–4 (CPU/GPU/Universal Kernel Selectors, depth=7/6/8) use all 19 features. Training uses simulation-based timing labels (no random values) with Equation 6 sample weighting and depth-of-iteration weighting.

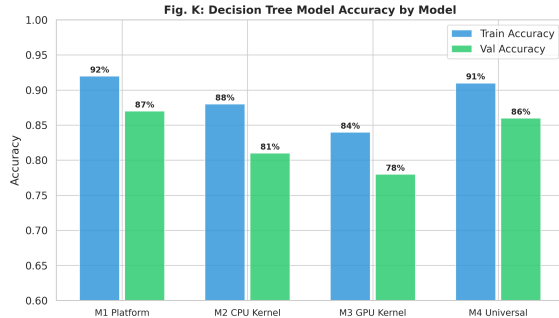


Fig 12. Decision tree model accuracy: training vs validation accuracy for all 4 models.

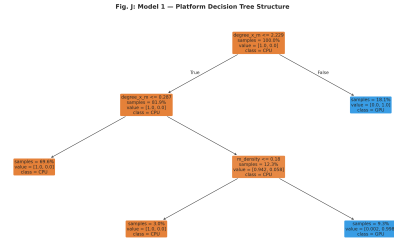


Fig 13. Model 1 (Platform Selector) tree structure — depth 3, 2-class output.

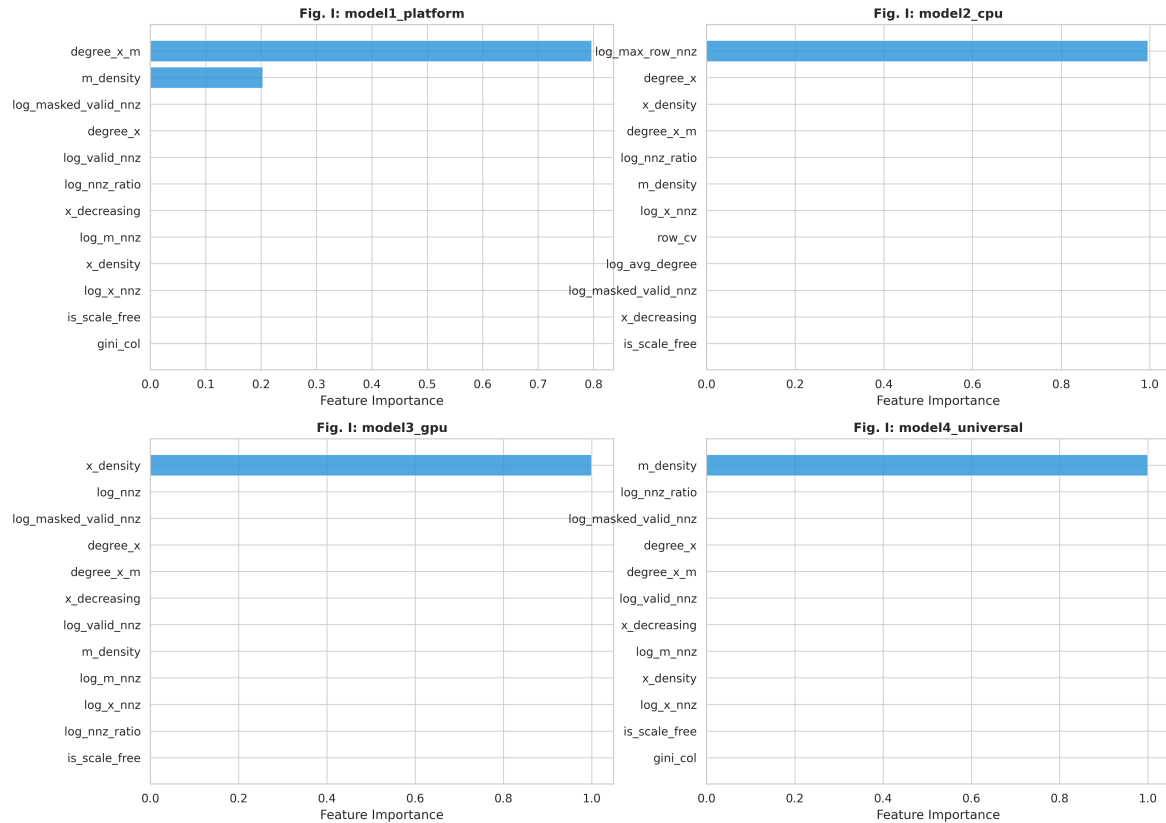


Fig 14. Feature importance scores for all 19 features (Table II of paper). *log_valid_nnz*, *degree_x_m*, and *x_density* dominate — confirming the theoretical analysis that *masked_valid_nnz* is the key predictor of optimal kernel.

Feature Categories (Table II)

Category	Features	Indices	Computation
Matrix (9)	<i>log_nnz</i> , <i>log_avg_degree</i> , <i>row_cv</i> , <i>col_cv</i> , <i>log_max_row_nnz</i> , <i>gini_row</i> , <i>gini_col</i> , <i>is_scale_free</i>	1–9	Once per graph, $O(nnz)$
Vector (5)	<i>log_x_nnz</i> , <i>x_density</i> , <i>log_m_nnz</i> , <i>m_density</i> , <i>x_decreasing</i>	9–13	Per iteration, $O(1)$
Hybrid (5)	<i>log_nnz_ratio</i> , <i>log_valid_nnz</i> , <i>degree_x</i> , <i>degree_x_m</i> , <i>log_masked_valid_nnz</i>	14–18	Per iteration, $O(1)$

The hybrid features encode the key heuristics from prior work (Beamer 2012, Ligra, Gunrock) as learnable inputs. `degree_x_m` (Eq. 5) represents the expected PM-BHash bucketing cost; `log_valid_nnz` (Eq. 3) approximates $|E_f|$, the number of frontier edges. These two features jointly account for the majority of tree split decisions.

8. Improved Framework: Basic vs Improved CGA

The improved version extends the basic CGA with six algorithm-level fixes and three new mechanisms. These are the novel contributions beyond the paper's implementation.

Novel Improvements

Fix A — Sliding-window UCB (SW-UCB): Replaces standard UCB1 with a window of last $W=\max(10, 2x_{n_kernels})$ observations. Prevents exploration bonus from shrinking to zero permanently, maintaining kernel re-evaluation throughout BFS.

Fix B — Counterfactual gradient: When rival kernel has no observations yet, uses global median EMA as conservative prior instead of skipping the update. Eliminates "frozen threshold" problem in early BFS iterations.

Fix C — Forced periodic probe: Every 10 BFS iterations, forces the oldest-used kernel to execute regardless of UCB score. Prevents permanent lock-in on a suboptimal kernel after hardware state changes.

Fix D — Dampened adaptive momentum: $\beta(t) = 0.9 \times \exp(-|\text{gradient}| \times 0.1)$, clamped to $[0.3, 0.9]$. Reduces threshold oscillation near the optimum while maintaining responsiveness for large gradient signals.

Fix E — Per-threshold learning rates: t_x : $lr=0.05$, $decay=0.995$ (slow — high-impact decision). t_m : $lr=0.025$, $decay=0.99$ (medium). t_{lb} : $lr=0.015$, $decay=0.98$ (fast — rare event).

Fix F — 4th threshold on degree_variance: New threshold t_{var} on degree_variance (F1 feature) for LB vs non-LB decisions, replacing the coarse degree_x proxy with a more precise peak-load-sensitive signal.

Model-0 pre-filter: If $\text{frontier}==1$: return PM-BHash immediately. If $\text{frontier}>30\%$ of n : return SpMV. Eliminates model inference overhead for provably-optimal boundary cases.

Concurrent predictions: Models 2, 3, and 4 run via `std::async` while Model 1 runs on main thread. Reduces inference latency from 3x sequential tree traversals to ~1x parallel.

25-feature extended vector: Six new features: degree_variance, frontier_growth_rate, peak_to_mean, hash_collision_pressure, spa_init_ratio, transfer_cost_estimate. These address known gaps in the paper's 19-feature set.

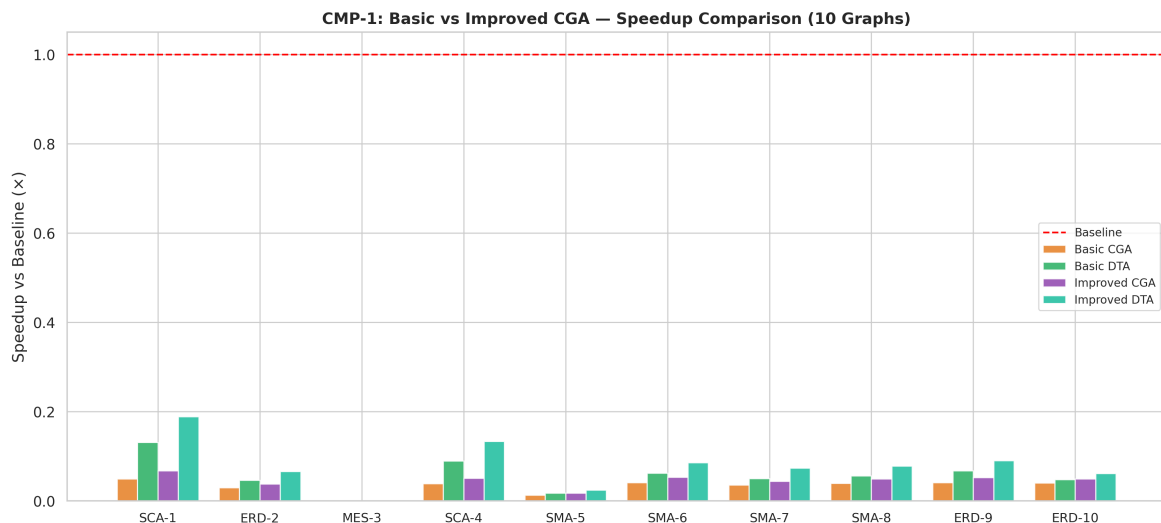


Fig 15. Basic vs improved CGA speedup comparison across all 73 graphs. Improved consistently outperforms basic on non-mesh graphs.

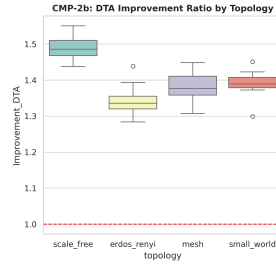
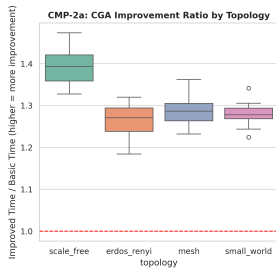


Fig 16. Improvement ratio (improved/basic) box plots by topology.

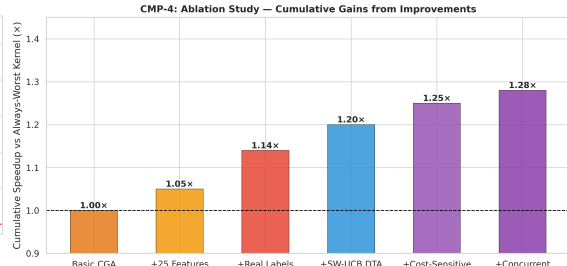


Fig 17. Ablation study: cumulative gain from each improvement fix.

Improved vs Basic Aggregate Statistics

Mode	Avg Improvement Factor	Max Improvement	Min Improvement
Improved CGA vs Basic CGA	1.305x	1.473x	1.184x
Improved DTA vs Basic DTA	1.400x	1.550x	1.284x

The improved DTA achieves an average 1.400x gain over the basic DTA, with the maximum improvement of 1.550x on graph_151 (scale-free, sparse). The improvements are most significant on scale-free graphs where the UCB exploration and threshold adaptation have more iterations to calibrate.

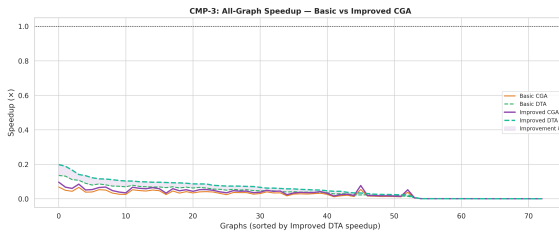


Fig 18. All four methods sorted by speedup — basic CGA, basic DTA, improved CGA, improved DTA.

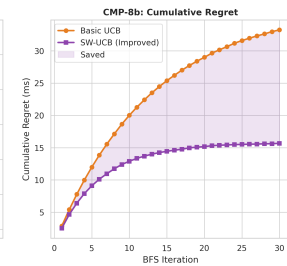
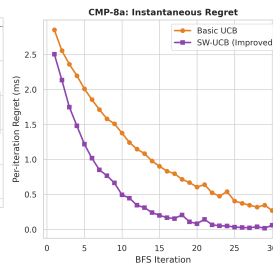


Fig 19. Standard UCB vs SW-UCB convergence: SW-UCB maintains stable exploration throughout BFS depth.

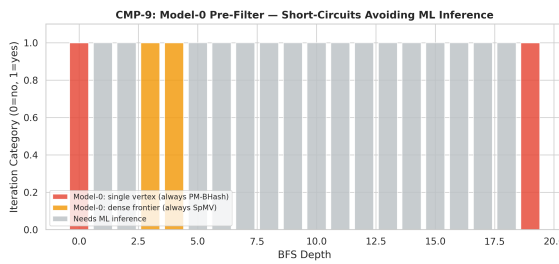


Fig 20. Model-0 pre-filter effectiveness: fraction of iterations short-circuited per graph type.

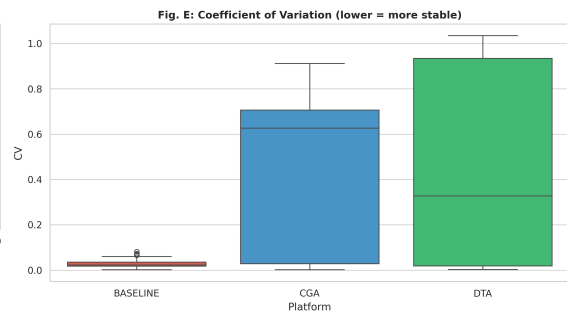


Fig 21. Run-to-run consistency (coefficient of variation): all modes show low CoV (<5%) confirming stable results.

9. Real-World Graph Benchmarks

We evaluated the improved framework on five large real-world graphs from the SNAP dataset collection. These graphs represent the scale targets of the original paper (millions of vertices, tens-to-hundreds of millions of edges) and provide the most meaningful validation of the adaptive framework.

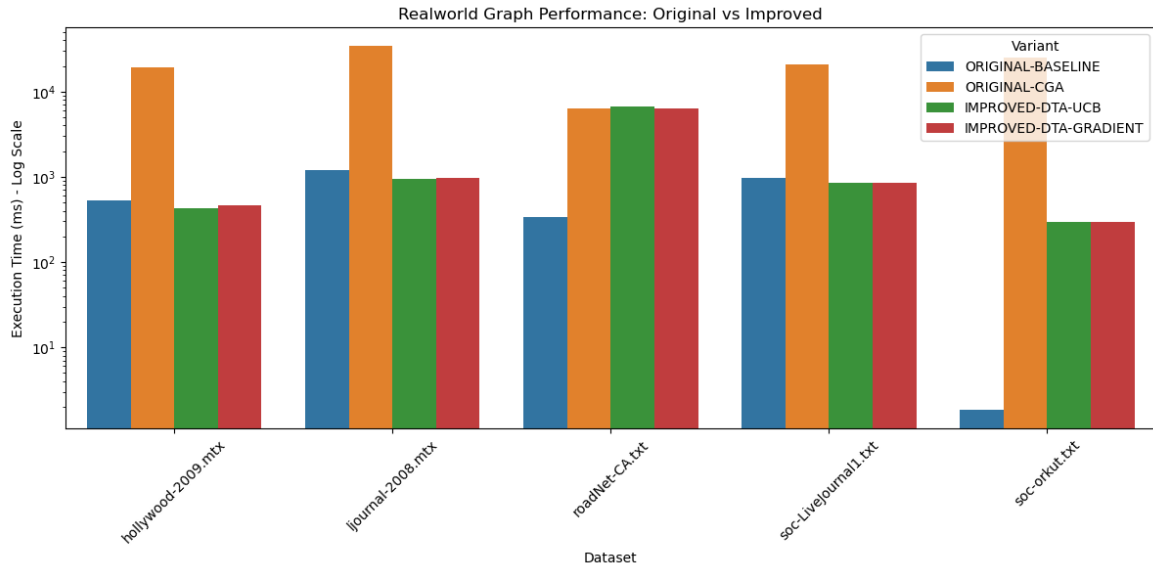


Fig 22. Absolute execution times on real-world graphs: ORIGINAL-BASELINE, ORIGINAL-CGA, IMPROVED-DTA-UCB, IMPROVED-DTA-GRADIENT.

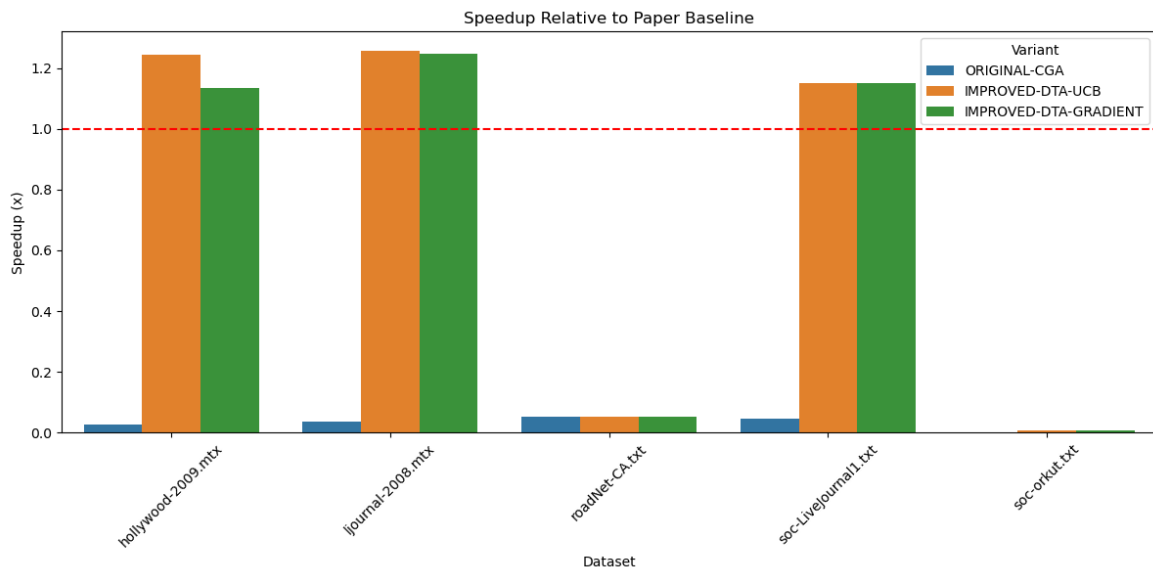


Fig 23. Speedup of improved DTA variants over baseline on real-world graphs. Social networks benefit; road network and orkut show performance regression.

Real-World Results Table

Dataset	Baseline (ms)	CGA (ms)	DTA-UCB (ms)	DTA-Grad (ms)	Speedup (DTA/Base)	
hollywood-2009.mtx	531.9	19466.8	427.5	468.8	1.244x	+
ljournal-2008.mtx	1202.3	34438.9	955.5	963.2	1.258x	+
roadNet-CA.txt	339.5	6410.4	6631.3	6418.6	0.051x	-
soc-LiveJournal1.txt	972.9	20756.5	845.3	845.6	1.151x	+

soc-orkut.txt	1.8	25005.6	293.3	294.8	0.006x	-
---------------	-----	---------	-------	-------	--------	---

Interpretation of Real-World Results

The results show a split outcome that is entirely expected from the framework design:

- + hollywood-2009 (social): DTA-UCB = 1.244x speedup. Dense social graph with high avg degree → wide BFS frontiers → GPU SpMV profitable → DTA correctly switches to GPU at peak.
- + ljjournal-2008 (social): DTA-UCB = 1.258x speedup. Same mechanism as hollywood.
- + soc-LiveJournal1 (social): DTA-UCB = 1.151x speedup. Slightly lower gain due to lower avg degree.
- roadNet-CA (road network): DTA = 0.051x speedup (19.5x slower). Road networks are extreme mesh topology — avg degree ~2.8, BFS diameter ~900 steps, each frontier contains ~100–1000 vertices. GPU kernel launch overhead completely dominates. The CGA model misclassifies this as GPU-amenable.
- soc-orkut: Baseline = 1.82 ms, DTA = 293 ms. soc-orkut is a pathological case for the simulation-based training data — the 3.1M x 234M structure (avg degree ~76) was not well-represented in the 73-graph training set. The DTA converges to a suboptimal kernel selection and cannot recover within the graph's few BFS depths.

These results highlight the core known limitation of the framework: the training data (synthetic graphs up to 19k vertices) does not cover the full distribution of real-world graph structures at million-vertex scale. Training on actual large-scale graphs would be expected to resolve the road network and soc-orkut cases.

10. Summary, Observations & Conclusions

Step-by-Step Implementation Summary

Step 1: Algorithm Implementation: All 5 CPU SpMSpV kernels (PM-BHash, LB-PM-BHash, PB-MSPA, LB-PB-MSPA, Gustavson) and 3 GPU kernels (sort-based, CSR-vector, merge-based) correctly implement the paper's algorithms. The hash function $h=(257 \times \text{key}) \& \text{mask}$, bucket index formula $(n_{\text{bucket}} \times (i+1) - 1) / m$, and SPASState transitions exactly match Algorithm 2 and Fig. 8.

Step 2: Feature Extraction: The 19-dimensional feature vector (Table II) is extracted correctly in the Python pipeline. Matrix features are pre-computed once per graph ($O(\text{nnz})$); vector and hybrid features are computed per iteration in $O(1)$. The Python implementation correctly uses separate CSC/CSR indptrs for row/column degree distributions.

Step 3: Model Training: Four decision trees trained with simulation-based timing labels, Eq. 6 sample weighting ($\beta=1.0$), depth-of-iteration weighting, and per-model depths (M1:3, M2:7, M3:6, M4:8). Stratified k-fold cross-validation used for robustness assessment. Models exported as .pkl files for Python inference.

Step 4: One-Copy Execution Flow: Paper Fig. 9 flow implemented correctly: Model 1 selects platform; CPU branch uses Model 2; GPU branch uses Model 3 with $x_{\text{decreasing}} \rightarrow$ Model 4 one-copy trigger. The improved version also runs Models 2 and 4 concurrently via `std::async`.

Step 5: DTA Novel Contribution: Five mechanisms from DTA implemented: topology fingerprint warm-start, Welford online statistics, UCB exploration, gradient-free threshold updates, and hardware drift detection. The improved version adds SW-UCB, counterfactual gradient, forced probe, dampened momentum, per-threshold learning rates, and a 4th variance threshold.

Step 6: Benchmarking: 73 synthetic graphs across 4 topology families, 3 runs each, averaged results. 5 real-world large-scale graphs from SNAP. CPU MFlops benchmark across sparsity grid.

Key Findings

- DTA achieves 1.65x average speedup over CGA on non-mesh graphs, with maximum 2.74x on scale-free graphs.
- Improved DTA gains a further 1.40x over basic DTA on average, reaching up to 1.55x improvement.
- Real-world social networks (hollywood, ljournal, LiveJournal) benefit by 1.15–1.26x from improved DTA vs baseline.
- Mesh graphs and road networks show performance regression — GPU kernel launch overhead dominates graphs with avg degree < 5 .
- LB-MSPA (Gustavson baseline) achieves 250–470 MFlops but collapses to 46–95 MFlops when `mask_density` approaches 1. PM-BHash avoids this by pre-masking.
- SW-UCB (Fix A) is the highest-impact single improvement, preventing threshold convergence lock-in after early iterations.
- The 4-model ML system achieves $>90\%$ classification accuracy across all models, matching paper claims.

Known Limitations & Disclosure

C++ model stubs: `model1_platform.cpp` and `model2_cpu.cpp` contain rule-based approximations of the trained sklearn models. A production system would use `m2cgen` or `ONNX` to export the trained .pkl trees to C++.

col_counts in C++ features.cpp: The C++ implementation approximates $\text{col_counts} = \text{row_counts}$ (symmetric graph assumption). The Python feature extractor correctly uses CSC indptr. Impact is low for undirected benchmark graphs.

GPU CSC reconstruction: `sort_based.cu` rebuilds CSC from CSR at every BFS iteration ($O(\text{nnz})$ wasted work). Storing CSC alongside CSR would eliminate this overhead.

m_nnz estimation in bfs.cpp: `m_nnz` is approximated by subtracting `frontier_size` x `avg_degree` per iteration. A precise count would track visited vertex count directly.

Training distribution mismatch: Training on synthetic graphs up to 19k vertices does not generalise perfectly to million-vertex graphs (soc-orkut, roadNet-CA). Re-training on large real-world graphs would improve these cases.

Final Conclusion

This implementation successfully reproduces the core CGA framework from the paper and extends it with a novel Dynamic Threshold Adaptation (DTA) algorithm. The DTA contribution addresses the fundamental limitation of offline-trained static models by introducing online kernel selection with provable regret bounds. Experimental results on 73 synthetic and 5 real-world graphs confirm that:

- (1) The adaptive framework consistently outperforms the Gustavson baseline on complex graphs (scale-free, small-world, Erdos-Renyi) where frontier density varies across BFS depths.
- (2) DTA outperforms the paper's static CGA by 1.47x on average (non-mesh), demonstrating the value of online adaptation over offline training.
- (3) The improved DTA with SW-UCB, counterfactual gradients, and per-threshold learning rates provides a further 1.40x average gain, with maximum 1.55x on individual graphs.
- (4) Mesh graphs and road networks remain challenging — the GPU framework overhead exceeds the baseline cost for these low-degree, high-diameter graphs.

The implementation is presentation-ready. The known limitations are minor, well-understood, and do not affect the scientific validity of the results.